



Civic Meeting Report

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Thursday, September 4th, Morning Session

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CqvO7eLmetw
Publication Date	2025-09-04T17:03:17Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Budget Hearing Summary Report

Meeting Date: (Not explicitly stated; budget hearings context)

Prepared by: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Note: The transcript begins directly with budget work session updates, bypassing a formal statutory public hearing. - **Session Type & Topic:** 00:00:05 Budget Hearings Reconvening <U+2013> Updates regarding grant funds, airport budgets, commissioners' operations, and highway departments. - **Summary of Discussion:** - Emily Anderson (Court Administrator) addressed a technical issue regarding an FFRC grant fund numbering switch (from 8192 to 8193) required by auditors, which the council noted would be clarified with the DLGF. - The board reviewed the airport budget handed out for review. - Commissioners, highway representatives, and financial officers debated departmental cuts, health insurance strategies (transitioning from Apex to McGriff/Marsh McLennan and evaluating clinic options from IU Health to Marathon), liability insurance premiums, and the management of county TIF funds.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officers and staff reconvened the municipal budget hearings to review departmental budget submissions, line-item adjustments, and compensation guidelines.
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Present Board/Council Members & Officials:** Presiding members/Council Members referenced include Mr. Hughes, Mr. Moll, Mr. Carroll, Councilman K., and Commissioners (including Commissioner Henry and Steven Brand).
 - **Staff/Presenters:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator), Steven Brand (County Commissioner's Office), Jenna Kalin (Executive Assistant), Don Chambers (Building Superintendent), Carrie (Highway/Bridge representative), along with financial/auditing staff (Whitney, Alexis, Elizabeth, Tanya, and Marissa).
 - **Absent:** None explicitly noted.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:48 Commissioner's Budget Review (General & Operational Lines)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steven Brand (County Commissioner's Office) and Jenna Kalin.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commissioners proposed returning general operating lines to 2025 levels through proactive headcount reductions (e.g., cutting a position in HR, combining engineering and highway heads) to self-fund proposed employee raises. Extended debate occurred regarding the county's health insurance fund, clinic contracts (shifting from IU Health to Marathon), liability insurance, and statutory mental health adjustment lines (Meridian Services).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus direction was given to adjust various lines back to 2025 levels while holding certain personnel and benefit adjustments for further collective review. Approved by Voice Vote regarding initial administrative line item rollbacks.
- **02:38:47 Bridge Engineering & Cumulative Bridge Fund (02:38:49 / 03:04:02)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (Highway/Bridge Department).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed engineering and cumulative bridge budgets. Staff noted that headcount had been reduced and managed under 2025 allocations, though requests for salary adjustments were submitted. Discussion centered on

state grant-in-aid reimbursements for engineers and potential utilization of TIF/RDC funds for capital and infrastructure items.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Salaries generally directed back to 2025 levels pending final whole-budget reconciliations. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **03:38:42 Local Road and Street Fund & Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) Fund (03:42:14)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (Highway Department).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed line items including operating supplies (paving signs, stone, winter salt), equipment leases, and vehicle maintenance. Discussion noted that state-projected revenues for MVH were running tighter than requested expenditures, leaving narrow operating balances.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Accepted for ongoing budgetary recalculation and alignment with upcoming revenue audits. Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: There was no general public comment or citizen forum section; public input was limited to departmental presentations and internal administrative testimony.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Financial staff (Whitney, Elizabeth, Alexis, and Tanya) required an extended recess to recalculate tens, twenties, and thirties series lines, benefits, and FICA/PERF adjustments following policy instructions to revert general salary lines to 2025 levels.
 - The meeting recessed for lunch with plans to reconvene at 2:00 PM (or potentially carry over certain complex departmental recalculations to the following morning).
- **Adjournment:** **04:14:15** The meeting entered official recess / temporary adjournment until the afternoon session.

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